

Waiting for Lightning to Strike

The myth that millionaires are simply *lucky* takes a lot of different forms, but they all come down to one main idea: obtaining wealth is random. People view wealth like lightning strikes, as though they have no control over when and where the million-dollar lightning bolt will strike next. They say things like, “Only special people strike it rich. Not me.” They think the only way to build wealth from nothing is to marry into money or invent the next iPhone. Since wealth is random, they see the lottery as a valid strategy. Hey, if building wealth is simply a game of chance, why not? Even if they don’t play Powerball or Mega Millions, they may believe that wealth comes down to a *DNA lottery*, a random mix of intellectual or physical advantages that enables only *some* people to become famous actors, athletes, models, or inventors. I think every one of these things is an excuse. It’s easier to believe that wealth is random—and, therefore, unattainable for *normal* people—than to hunker down and go about the hard work of building wealth.

Our research has found that most millionaires are self-made. That is, they started with nothing, worked hard using the principles and attributes I’ll discuss later in this book, and built wealth over time. That’s the long road, though. When I sit down with someone and show them how they, too, can become a millionaire, I often see a flash of defeat wash over the person’s face. People usually don’t want to hear about a twenty-year plan for building wealth. They want to take a shortcut, and they’ve convinced themselves that’s how most millionaires made their money. They’ve come to believe millionaires get their wealth through luck, lottery, marriage, or special advantages, and they use that belief to excuse their own lack of effort. Why even try to build wealth if you don’t think you’re one of the “special” people?

Listen, I want you to get to that point of million-dollar net worth, and I’m going to show you that you have what it takes to win. But just know, sitting